

Thai Coconut Chicken Soup (Tom Kha Gai) (Variation 1)

Tags: soup, thai, gluten-free, dinner | Prep: 15 min | Cook: 25 min | Serves: 10

Ingredients

- 5 cans (400 ml each) full-fat coconut milk
- 1250 ml chicken stock
- 10 stalks lemongrass, bruised and cut into 5 cm pieces
- 15 slices galangal or fresh ginger (3 mm thick)
- 10 kaffir lime leaves, torn
- 7.5 Thai bird's eye chillies, bruised
- 1250 g boneless chicken thighs, thinly sliced
- 500 g oyster mushrooms, torn
- 7.5 tbsp fish sauce
- 2.5 tbsp palm sugar or brown sugar
- Juice of 5 limes
- fresh dill to serve
- Thinly sliced red chilli to serve

Method

1. Combine coconut milk and chicken stock in a large saucepan over medium heat. Bring to a gentle simmer.
2. Add lemongrass, galangal, lime leaves, and chillies. Simmer for 5 minutes to infuse.
3. Add sliced chicken and mushrooms. Simmer for 8–10 minutes until chicken is cooked through.
4. Season with fish sauce and sugar. Stir to dissolve.
5. Remove from heat and add lime juice. Taste — the soup should be salty, sour, and slightly sweet.
6. Adjust with more fish sauce (salt), lime juice (sour), or sugar (sweet) to balance.
7. Ladle into bowls, discarding lemongrass and galangal if preferred.
8. Top with fresh cilantro and sliced chilli.

Chef Tips

- Galangal is traditional and distinct from ginger — use it if you can find it at Asian grocers.
- Do not boil after adding lime juice or the soup will become bitter.
- Kaffir lime leaves are key; freeze extras for future use.